

money, so when Aunt Honey shared a Duncan Hines cake “\$1 refund” form with Lisa, along with a copy of a refund magazine, it piqued her interest. Who didn’t want free cake mix? Raising seven children in the coupon-friendly area of Pennsylvania, Lisa credits coupons for her ability to save as much as 90 percent on her grocery bill, depending on the sales, and the double (or even triple at one time) coupon opportunities.

Once her children were all out of the house, Lisa discovered she had an unusual problem—she couldn’t stop “buying” all the free stuff local stores were offering her. The deals were just too enticing, despite the fact that she no longer needed the huge stockpiles that filled three freezers and an entire basement full of shelves. When the stockpile threatened to take over her house, she began including some of the stockpile in annual garage sales, as well as donating to a woman’s shelter and allowing her adult children to “shop” in Mom’s downstairs store.

Lisa’s favorite store changes just as often as the deals do, but at the time of our interview even Lisa couldn’t believe the amazing deals she’d been getting at Rite Aid. Combining sale prices, coupons, and the UP register rewards, Lisa once ended up with ninety-eight Johnson & Johnson baby products totally free. Besides keeping her own grandchildren well-stocked with baby products, she filled gift baskets for baby showers and church raffles with those deals.



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